

SI-GEN-030 - EastRefinery General Safety Instructions for Alarm Response

Document ID: SI-GEN-030 Revision: 5.1 Effective Date: 1 January 2026 Site: EastRefinery Owner: Process Safety / Operations Audience: All operations and maintenance personnel responding to alarms

1. Why this document exists

Alarms are easy to treat like screen noise. On a bad day they are the early warning that someone can get hurt, a unit can trip, or a small leak can become a big event. These rules apply across EastRefinery whenever you respond to alarms.

2. Golden rules

1. People first, then environment, then equipment, then production.
2. Never bypass a safety interlock to clear an alarm or keep rate up.
3. Do not restart tripped critical equipment until the cause is understood well enough to restart safely.
4. Treat an unverified field condition as hazardous until you know otherwise.
5. If you are unsure, stop and escalate. Guessing is not a response strategy.

3. Critical alarm behaviour

1. Acknowledge promptly so others know someone owns it.
2. Assess consequence before you start changing things.
3. Use the approved procedure for that asset class.
4. Keep radio talk short and specific.
5. Record times and actions.
6. During a flood, work the alarms that protect people and prevent trips first.

Acknowledging an alarm is not the same as fixing it. Do not clear responsibility when the condition is still live.

4. Before you go to the field

1. Wear the PPE required for that unit.
2. Check gas detection requirements where they apply.
3. Know your exit path, muster point, and nearest eyewash / safety shower.
4. Assume hot surfaces and pressure leaks are possible around pumps and compressors.
5. Tell the board where you are going and what alarm you are checking.

If the board already suspects a spray or gas release, do not walk in "just to confirm" without a plan.

5. Write actions and approvals

Creating tickets is fine. Changing protective setpoints, inhibiting alarms, or forcing protection out of service is not a casual act.

Rules:

1. Protective inhibits need explicit supervisor approval and a recorded reason.
2. Copilot tools may suggest actions. They must not silently execute unprotected write operations.
3. If a recommendation conflicts with a safety instruction, follow the safety instruction.

6. Emergency conditions

If you see a major leak, fire, toxic release, or uncontrolled pressure event:

1. Start the unit emergency response.
2. Move yourself and others to a safe place.
3. Do not stay to "finish the troubleshooting."
4. Only operate local valves if you are trained for that emergency duty and directed to do it.

7. Shift handover

Hand over open critical alarms with:

- Current status
- Actions already tried
- Who was called
- What still needs doing
- Any inhibits or temporary measures in place

8. Related documents

- AP-ER-040
- Unit operating procedures
- Site emergency response plan
- Asset-specific safety instructions such as SI-BFP-031 and SI-CMP-032